

Small Business Cybersecurity Basics

Sample Security Assessment Checklist — Consulting Deliverable

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Purpose	Sample of the security review clients receive as a consulting deliverable
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Most breaches don't come from sophisticated zero-days — they come from the basics being skipped. This checklist reflects the kind of practical, no-jargon review a client gets when they bring me in to assess their small business or home-office setup. Each item is checked against their environment, with plain-language findings and next steps — not a wall of acronyms nobody reads.

1. Account & Access Security

Check Item	What We're Looking For	Status
Strong, unique passwords	No reused passwords across critical accounts; password manager in use	
Multi-factor authentication (MFA)	MFA enabled on email, banking, and admin-level accounts	
User access review	Staff only have access to systems/data required for their role	
Former employee access	Accounts disabled promptly when staff leave the business	

2. Device & Network Hygiene

Check Item	What We're Looking For	Status
OS and software updates	Devices set to auto-update or updated on a regular schedule	
Antivirus / endpoint protection	Active, up-to-date protection on all business devices	
Router/firewall configuration	Default admin credentials changed; firmware current	
Wi-Fi security	WPA2/WPA3 encryption in use; guest network isolated from business systems	

3. Data & Backup Practices

Check Item	What We're Looking For	Status
Regular backups	Critical data backed up on a schedule, stored separately from the source	
Backup restore test	Backups have been tested to confirm they actually restore	
Sensitive data handling	Customer/financial data stored and shared securely, not over plain email	

4. Human Factor

Check Item	What We're Looking For	Status
Phishing awareness	Staff can recognize suspicious emails/links and know who to report to	
Incident response plan	There's a basic, written plan for what to do if something goes wrong	

Deliverable format: Every engagement ends with a completed version of this checklist, a short plain-language summary of what's solid and what needs attention, and a prioritized list of fixes — starting with whatever poses the biggest risk first.

This is a sample template — actual assessments are tailored to your specific setup.